UNIVERSITY OF LAGOS,

FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF BUSINESS ADMINSTRATION

COURSE TITLE: STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT & BUSINESS POLICY

COURSE CODE: FBA/BUS 410, 2021/2022

TOPIC: STRATEGIC IMPLEMENTATION

STRATEGY IMPLEMENTATION

Strategy implementation: is the process of turning plans into action to reach a desired outcome. Essentially, it's the art of getting stuff done. The success of every organization rests on its capacity to implement decisions and execute key processes efficiently, effectively, and consistently. Strategic implementation refers to the process of executing plans and activating strategies. These processes aim to achieve long-term goals within an organization. Strategic implementation, in other words, is a technique through which a firm develops. It utilizes and integrates new processes into the structure of an organization. Strategy implementation is the fourth step in the strategic management process and it's where you turn your strategic plan into action. It is the sum total of all the activities and choices required for execution of a strategic plan.

Simply put, strategy implementation is the technique through which the firm develops, utilises and integrates its structure, culture, resources, people and control system to follow the strategies to have the edge over other competitors in the market. It is followed by Strategic Evaluation and Control.

STRATEGY ACTIVATION

Strategy activation: describes a continuous cycle of improvement to eliminate the gap, incorporating real-time feedback to promote collective enterprise engagement with strategic initiatives.

Strategy activation eliminates the gap between development and execution. It moves people into action. The skills, tactics, techniques, and approaches that fit under this heading of strategy activation are broad. They encompass many topics and skills—brand, culture, technology, neuroscience, communication, and visual design, to name a few. However, there are a few fundamental concepts that can strengthen any organization’s approach to strategy activation. Successful strategy activation depends on clarity, repetition, and storytelling.

Align key stakeholders

Strategy activation starts with alignment. There are many levels of alignment:

- Align the board and executives on what the strategy is.
- Align executives and other senior leaders on the culture, purpose, and principles that give shape to how strategy comes to life.
- Align senior leaders and middle management on the how and why of strategy activation.

Alignment reduces conflict and creates a foundation for the efficient deployment of strategy. In contrast, the lack of alignment will bog an organization down in continuous internal meetings and endless debate.

Strategy is activated through people.

The idea of strategy activation through people feels fairly intuitive. Yet, how often do we talk about ***what*** our strategy activation plan is? How much attention is given to ***how*** this strategy activation will occur? How well do we account for the neuroscience research that helps us understand ***why*** activating a new strategy is so difficult? Lastly, how do we know ***when*** and ***where*** it's working to help us reach our goals and the organization's potential?

Begin activation with on-boarding

Strategy activation needs to begin prior to the on-boarding process of new employees. Employees need to be given a consistent story and a well-orchestrated, synthesized on-boarding experience that helps them see, hear, and live the strategy before their first day on the job. Building robust on-boarding platforms and employee support systems are essential to both the initial strategy activation and the ongoing (and inevitable) adaptation and change to the strategy. Experience design is a critical skill set in the strategy activation process to get this piece right.

Empower middle managers

Strategy activation is highly dependent on middle managers. Real work gets led in the middle of most organizations and executed on the front lines. That's where we touch the customer. That's where processes work—or don't. That's where daily decisions are made that result in an efficient, high-quality, customer-centric organization (or result in something else).
Unfortunately, middle managers are generally overloaded and under pressure from many directions. They are expected to operate the business, advocate for change, lead people, and answer to other leaders all while making sure customers are happy and quality is high. It's essential to provide middle managers with significant support for strategy activation. This might start with:

- Clear, simple visual design of support tools that help explain ideas
- Info graphics that communicate models in simple ways
- Short video snippets that provide just-in-time support

These tactics and others make middle managers' lives easier. Regardless of the approach, effective strategy activation requires us to arm managers with the tools to support the front lines; the skills to handle the pressures placed upon them; and the space and support network to process their roles throughout the activation process.

As we've shown above, strategy activation is highly dependent on the people who report to members of the leadership team - referred to as middle managers, people leaders - this is where the real work gets done - it's the operational hub of any company. This is where processes work, or don't and where the customer experience is delivered.

Middle managers and people managers are also the most overloaded and under pressure population of people within an organisation - being responsible for the day to day operational performance of the business, lead and manage change, lead people in their functional areas so they are engaged and productive, report to senior leaders while also making sure customers are happy

and quality is high. This level within any organisation must be ready for and committed to strategy activation or it won't work.

Design the employee experience

Activation requires support systems and points of integration. The tools, technologies, and general infrastructure that exist in an organization can be invaluable resources in the strategy activation process. If strategy depends upon people, then thinking through the employee's experience—and the entire ecosystem that surrounds them, which includes numerous systems and technologies—is essential to bringing strategy to life. Rather than seeing software as a barrier to be learned, effective strategy activation requires us to design the employee's work environment to maximize their effectiveness.

Embrace an iterative approach

Finally, recognize that strategy activation is not linear; it's iterative. Neither strategy nor strategy activation are ever "finished." It's important to embrace this mindset. The process of strategy activation requires feedback loops whereby messages, ideas, priorities, and processes are deployed to the organization, and then data and information are gathered in the deployment process to be fed back into the strategy activation plan as well as the strategy itself

STRUCTURAL IMPLEMENTATION OF STRATEGIES

It is the arrangement of tasks and sub tasks required to implement a strategy. Diagrammatic representation could be organizational chart but administrative mechanism provides flesh and blood to the organization structure.

An implementation structure is the administrative entity which programme implementers use for accomplishing objectives within programmes.

Structure supports strategy. If an organization changes its strategy, it must change its structure to support the new strategy. When it doesn't, the structure acts like a bungee cord and pulls the organization back to its old strategy. Strategy follows structure.

Why organizational structure is so important in strategy implementation?
Organizational structure improves operational efficiency by providing clarity to employees at all levels of a company. By paying mind to the organizational structure, departments can work more like well-oiled machines, focusing time and energy on productive tasks.
The maxim: "**Structure follows Strategy**." That is to say, all aspects of an organization's structure, from the creation of divisions and departments to the designation of reporting relationships, should be made while keeping the organization's strategic intent in mind.

BEHAVIOURAL IMPLEMENTATION

Behavioural implementation deals with those aspects of strategy implementation that have impact on behaviour of people in the organization. Since human resources form an integral part of the organization, their activities and behaviour need to be directed in a certain way. Any departure may lead to the failure of strategy.

Strategic implementation requires **support, discipline, motivation and hard work** from all manager and employees. For this they must develop and communicate the vision of the future and motivate organizational members to move into that direction.

It is vital to bear in mind that organizational change is not an intellectual process concerned with the design of ever-more-complex and elegant organization structures. It has to do with the human side of enterprise and is essentially about changing people's attitudes, feelings and – above all else – their behavior. The behavioral of the employees affect the success of the organization.

Influence Tactics: The organizational leaders have to successfully implement the strategies and achieve the objectives. Therefore the leader has to change the behavior of superiors, peers or subordinates. For this they must develop and communicate the vision of the future and motivate organizational members to move into that direction.

Power: it is the potential ability to influence the behavior of others. Leaders often use their power to influence others and implement strategy. Formal authority that comes through leaders position in the organization (He cannot use the power to influence customers and government officials). The leaders have to exercise something more than that of the formal authority (Expertise, charisma, reward power, information power, legitimate power, coercive power)

Empowerment as a way of Influencing Behavior: The top executives have to empower lower level employees. Training, self managed work groups eliminating whole levels of management in organization and aggressive use of automation are some of the ways to empower people at various places.

POLITICAL IMPLICATIONS OF POWER

Organization politics is defined as those set of activities engaged in by people in order to acquire, enhance and employ power and other resources to achieve preferred outcomes in organizational setting characterized by uncertainties. Organization must try to manage political behavior while implementing strategies. They should;

- Define job duties clearly.
- Design job properly.
- Demonstrate proper behaviors.
- Promote understanding.
- Allocate resources judiciously.

Values and Culture: Value is something that has worth and importance to an individual. People should have shared values. This value keeps everyone from the top management down to factory persons on the factory floor pulling in the same direction.

Ethics and Strategy: Ethics are contemporary standards and a principle or conducts that govern the action and behavior of individuals within the organization. In order that the business systems function successfully the organization has to avoid certain unethical practices and the organization has to bind by legal laws and government rules and regulations.

Managing Resistance to Change: To change is almost always unavoidable, but its strength can be minimized by careful advance. Top management tends to see change in its strategic context. Rank-and-file employees are most likely to be aware of its impact on important aspects of their working lives. Some resistance planning, which involves thinking about such issues as: *Who* will be affected by the proposed changes, both directly and indirectly? From their point of view, *what*

aspects of their working lives will be affected? *Who should communicate* information about change, *when* and *by what means*? What *management style* is to be used?

Managing Conflict: Conflict is a process in which an effort is purposefully made by one person or unit to block another that results in frustrating the attainment of the others goals or the furthering of his interests. The organization has to resolve the conflicts.

WHAT IS FUNCTIONAL STRATEGY?

Functional strategies: help in implementation of grand strategy by organizing and activating specific subunits of the company to pursue the business strategy in daily activities. In a sense, functional strategies translate grand strategy into action designed to accomplish specific annual objectives.

Functional Strategy is the strategic plan adopted by each functional area in the value chain of the organization like marketing, production, finance, human resources, IT etc. to implement and align with the overall business or corporate strategy/vision for achieving organizational level objectives.

The value chain of a company comprises of various departments and functions like core functions like finance, marketing, sales and auxiliary functions like HR, IT etc. All these functions may align with the overall organization vision or strategy but each department has its own needs and targets for which they need more refined finer strategy. This finer strategy which is specific to that particular function to achieve their targets becomes functional strategy.

The functional strategy of a company is customized to a specific industry or strategic business unit (SBU) and is used to back up other corporate and business strategies. Each department develops certain objectives, which is to be enforced by employees, and aids in the achievement of final organizational goals.

A functional strategy provides guidance reviewing operational income, evaluating various funding options and deciding on the capital structure mix that gives the lowest cost of capital. These way different functions in the value chain of an organization will have their own strategies to achieve the larger goals of the company.

Functional Strategy Example

Marketing strategy involves decisions related to pricing, selling, advertising and distributing a product. The aim could be to increase market share, venture into newer markets, penetrate existing markets, launch new products or deal with distributors/ competitors. The overall strategy of the company can be to become number 1 company in terms of sales for multiple geographies. The functional strategy for marketing in the example aligns with that vision but has its own refined approach to achieve marketing objective to help the company overall.

OPERATIONAL IMPLEMENTATION

According to, Azhar Kazmi (2008), operational implementation strategy is the approach adopted by an organisation to achieve operational effectiveness. When an organisation performs value-creating activities optimally and in better way than its competitors can perform it results in operational effectiveness.

Operations strategy is a guiding principle used to plan, analyze, and execute a company's operations. Businesses use operations strategies to identify and implement cost-effective processes

for creating and distributing products and services. An operations strategy supports a company's overall business strategy in order to maximize profits.

What Are Operations Resources and Market Requirements?

Operations resources: include a wide variety of company resources like equipment, people, facilities, vendors, and technology. Operations managers oversee the scope of a company's operations resources and monitor how those resources facilitate products or services.

Market requirements: refer to business goals and operational plans for how to meet market needs. Market requirements are an essential part of any operations strategy as they determine the cost, quality, and lead time of a product or service in order to meet customer expectations.

Five Key Elements of an Operations Strategy

There are a few key elements that go into a company's operations strategy.

1. **Production system**: An organization's production system determines the short-term and long-term planning for how resources are turned into marketable products and services. A comprehensive production system includes clear workflows, quality control benchmarks, and supply chain management strategies.
2. **Facilities**: A company's operational capabilities are influenced by the size and number of production facilities. To function properly, specific facilities require achievable production goals, clear safety procedures, and inventory management systems.
3. **Product or service**: One of the most important elements of any operations strategy is the quality management of a product or service. Businesses analyze the lifecycle of their products and services in order to predict market trends, adjust their product or service, and allocate resources to new service development and product development.
4. **Technology**: Operations strategy increasingly depends on new technological developments like machine learning, production line automation, real-time metrics, and market forecasting tools.
5. **Resources**: A comprehensive overall strategy for operations takes into account the total operations resources available to an organization, including location, mechanical, and human resources.

Five Types of Operations Strategies

Businesses employ different types of operations strategies based on their specific market needs.

1. **Core competency strategies**: Core competency operations strategies revolve around the main strengths of a company's business model. By identifying the best core business processes within an organization, core competency operations strategies focus on leveraging existing strengths to maximize profitability.
2. **Corporate strategies**: This type of operations strategy adheres to a company's mission statement and aligns itself to a larger corporate strategy. Businesses using this type of operations strategy develop production initiatives, key performance indicators (KPIs), and decision-making processes based on an overall strategic plan determined by company leaders and stakeholders.
3. **Competitive strategies**: Companies using this type of strategy develop their operations processes in order to distinguish their product or service from competitors. By identifying competitive priorities within a specific economy, businesses can change their operations strategy to move toward a competitive advantage, whether that's a higher-quality product or a faster lead time during production.

4. **Product or service strategies**: This type of operations strategy revolves around the quality control of existing products or services as well as the development of new products and services. Businesses using this model often determine their operations strategies based on the research and ideas from product managers.
5. **Customer-driven strategies**: Organizations using customer-driven strategies make operations decisions based on the customer experience. This type of operations strategy aligns with sales and marketing strategies to manage and fulfil customer expectations.

Example of Operations Strategy

An example of an operations strategy is a furniture retailer deciding to change its manufacturing strategy by outsourcing production to an automated facility. By using new technological resources, this hypothetical furniture company can manage its supply chain better and create products faster to improve its competitive position.

COURSE TITLE: CHANGE MANAGEMENT

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TOPIC: CHANGE COMMUNICATION MODELS: ARMENNKIS, ELVING MODELS

What is change management communication? It is the transmission of information that tells employees what is changing, how this change will affect them, and what they need to do next. It helps people advance from where they presently are, to the new condition required of them. It is more than just a tool to introduce new ways of working and structural adjustment. It is about transmitting the mindsets of change. Change communications differs from the general internal communications definition in that, it has a strong